

Words ending in -able or -ible

SPELLING WORDS WITH SIMILAR-SOUNDING SUFFIXES CAN BE CONFUSING.

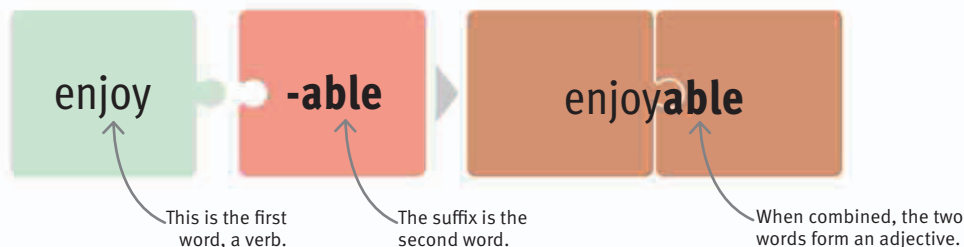
The suffixes *-able* and *-ible* both mean “able to.” For example, *adaptable* means “able to adapt.” However, it can be difficult to decide which suffix to use, as they are not interchangeable.

Words ending in -able

The suffix *-able* is usually added to complete words to turn them into adjectives. Learning a few simple rules makes it easier to decide which suffix to use. More words end in *-able* than *-ible*, so, if in doubt, choose *-able*. Best of all, check the correct spelling in a dictionary.

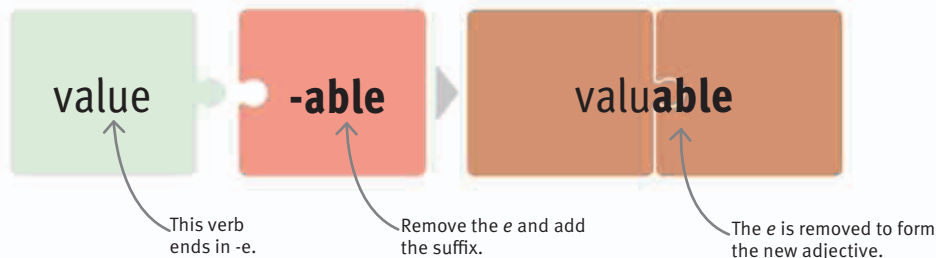
▷ Rule 1

Words ending in *-able* are usually formed from two separate words that make sense individually.



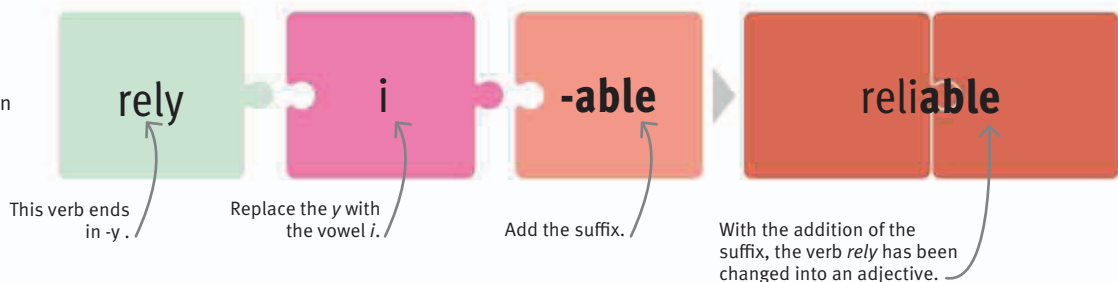
▷ Rule 2

When *-able* is added to a word that ends in *-e*, the *e* is usually removed.



▷ Rule 3

Often, if a word ends in *-y*, the *y* is replaced with an *i* before the suffix *-able* is added.



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GLOSSARY

Adjective A word that describes a noun.

Suffix A group of letters attached to the end of a word that can change the original word's meaning.

Syllable A unit of pronunciation that has one vowel sound.

Verb A word that describes an action.

Vowel One of the five letters *a*, *e*, *i*, *o*, and *u*.